Mom's Advance Directive & DNR — Pre-Filled Draft

This document handles the "who's in charge of medical decisions" and "do not resuscitate" questions mom mentioned.

It has two parts that work together:

- **Part A — Healthcare Power of Attorney:** Names the person who speaks for mom if she can't speak for herself
- **Part B — Living Will:** States her specific wishes (including DNR)

ADVANCE DIRECTIVE FOR HEALTHCARE

IDENTIFICATION

I, **[MOM'S FULL LEGAL NAME]** Date of Birth: **[DOB]** Address: **[STREET ADDRESS, CITY, STATE, ZIP]** Phone: **[PHONE]**

being of sound mind, voluntarily make this Advance Directive to state my wishes for healthcare in the event I become unable to make or communicate those decisions myself.

PART A — HEALTHCARE POWER OF ATTORNEY

1. My Healthcare Agent

I appoint the following person to make healthcare decisions for me if I am unable to do so:

Primary Agent: Name: **[NAME — e.g., one of the kids]** Relationship: **[e.g., daughter / son]** Phone (cell): **[PHONE]** Phone (alternate): **[PHONE]** Address: **[ADDRESS]**

Alternate Agent (if the primary is unavailable): Name: **[ALTERNATE NAME — e.g., the other kid]** Relationship: **[e.g., daughter / son]** Phone (cell): **[PHONE]** Phone (alternate): **[PHONE]** Address: **[ADDRESS]**

2. Powers Granted to My Agent

My Agent is authorized to:

- Consent to, refuse, or withdraw any medical treatment, procedure, or surgery
- Access all of my medical records (this includes **HIPAA authorization**)
- Choose my doctors, hospitals, and care facilities
- Move me between facilities as needed
- Authorize or refuse pain medication
- Make decisions about life-sustaining treatment consistent with Part B below
- Authorize organ/tissue donation consistent with my wishes in Part B

- Make decisions about autopsy and disposition of my remains

3. When My Agent's Authority Begins

My Agent's authority takes effect when my attending physician determines that I am unable to make or communicate my own healthcare decisions. It ends if I regain that ability.

PART B — LIVING WILL (MY SPECIFIC WISHES)

4. When These Wishes Apply

The instructions below apply if I am in **any** of the following conditions, as determined by my attending physician and confirmed by a second physician:

- A **terminal condition** (incurable, expected to cause death soon)
- A **permanent unconscious state** (persistent vegetative state or irreversible coma)
- An **end-stage medical condition** where recovery to a meaningful quality of life is not possible

5. Do Not Resuscitate (DNR)

☐ **If my heart stops or I stop breathing under the conditions in Section 4, I DO NOT want cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR), defibrillation, or intubation. I want a DO NOT RESUSCITATE order.**

(Mom: check the box if this is your wish. Leave unchecked if you want CPR attempted.)

⚠ **Important:** For paramedics to honor a DNR in an emergency at home, you typically also need a separate **POLST or MOLST form** signed by your doctor. Ask her primary care doctor at her next visit — they fill it out in about 10 minutes. That's the form that rides on the fridge and EMTs actually follow.

6. Life-Sustaining Treatment

If I am in one of the conditions in Section 4, my wishes for life-sustaining treatment are:

☐ **I do NOT want** life-sustaining treatments that merely prolong the dying process. I want to be allowed to die naturally, with comfort care only.

☐ I want life-sustaining treatment for a **trial period**, after which my Agent should reassess based on whether I'm improving.

☐ **I DO want** all available life-sustaining treatments, regardless of prognosis.

(Mom: check one.)

7. Specific Treatments

Even under the conditions in Section 4, my wishes for specific treatments are:

Treatment	I do NOT want	I DO want	Agent decides
CPR / resuscitation	☐	☐	☐

Witnesses should NOT be: the named Healthcare Agent, the alternate Agent, mom's doctor, an employee of her healthcare facility, or anyone who would inherit from her.

Witness 1:

Signature: _____ Printed Name: _____
Address: _____ Date: _____

Witness 2:

Signature: _____ Printed Name: _____
Address: _____ Date: _____

NOTARY ACKNOWLEDGMENT

STATE OF _____ COUNTY OF _____

On this ___ day of _____, 20**___**, before me personally appeared **[MOM'S FULL LEGAL NAME]**, known to me (or proved on satisfactory evidence) to be the person whose name is subscribed to this instrument, who acknowledged that she executed it voluntarily for the purposes stated.

_____ Notary Public My commission expires: _____

[NOTARY SEAL]

AFTER SIGNING — DO THESE THINGS

1. **Give copies to:**
   - Her primary doctor (ask them to file it in her chart)
   - The named Healthcare Agent (you or sibling)
   - The alternate Agent
   - The local hospital if there's one she'd most likely go to
   - Keep an original at home somewhere findable
2. **Ask her doctor about a POLST/MOLST form** — this is the one-page medical order that paramedics actually follow. Put it on the fridge.
3. **Wallet card** — a small card noting "I have an Advance Directive" with the Agent's phone number is smart
4. **Review every few years** or after major life changes

Disclaimer: This is a template, not legal advice. Many states have their own official advance directive form that may be preferred — google "[state] advance directive form" to find yours. Either way, the signing, witness, and notary requirements should be followed.